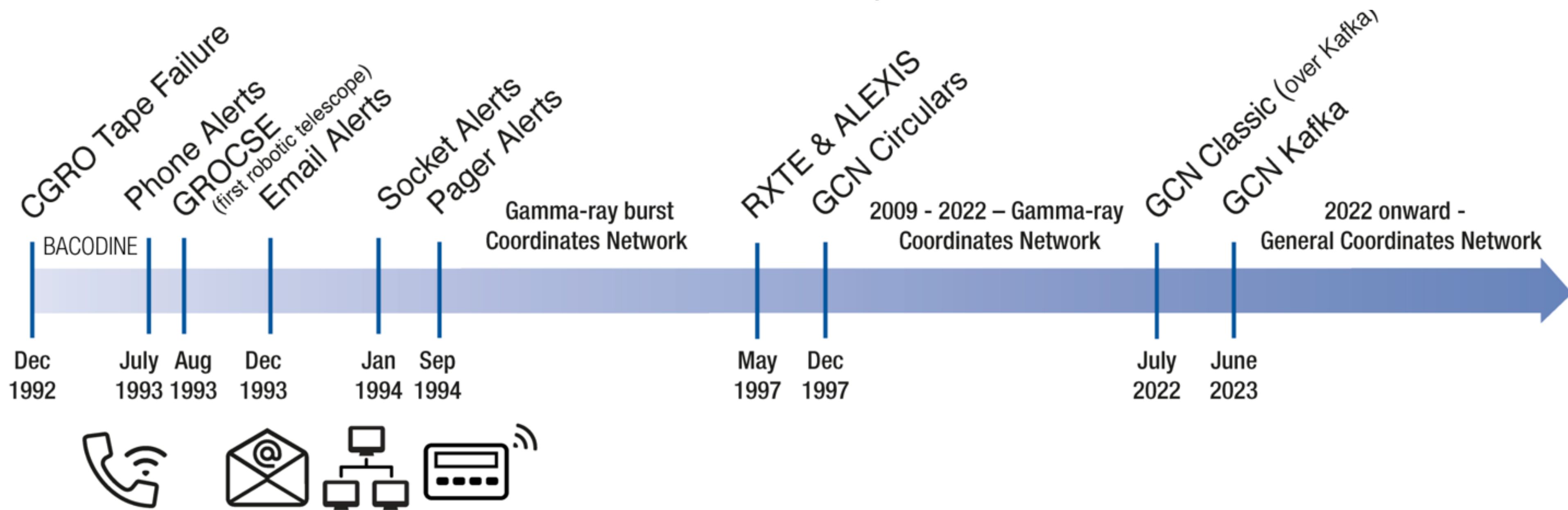


GCN (Gamma-ray Coordinates Network)

- A system for the rapid distribution of alerts from high-energy astrophysical transients.
- **Originally designed to share gamma-ray burst (GRB)** detections in real time.
- Provides:
 - Automatic notifications (**GCN Notices**) for detections of astronomical transient.
 - Human-readable reports (**GCN Circulars**) for follow-up observations.
 - Machine-readable event feeds (VOEvents, JSON streams) in extreme low-latency

Historical Background



- **1993:** GCN established by NASA's Goddard Space Flight Center.
- Initially connected **CGRO/BATSE** with ground-based observatories. To enable immediate follow-up by ground based robotic telescopes. Technology based on phone calls, mails, alerts via internet
- **1990s–2000s:** Expansion to include **Swift**, **INTEGRAL**, **Fermi-GBM**, and other missions. Still focused on gamma-ray astronomy
- Finally extended to the full Time-Domain and multi-messenger community, including gravitational waves, neutrinos, fast radio bursts, SN, optical transients, FBOTs...